

Reskilling & Job-Hunt Roadmap (9+ YOE)

Azure → Docker → Kubernetes → Terraform → Node.js → React → Next.js → Traditional AI/ML → Vector DBs → Gen AI/RAG

Rule: One topic at a time, in order. Do not start topic 2 until topic 1’s checklist is done. Within each topic, learn sub-topics in the sequence listed (earlier items are prerequisites for later ones).

PART 0 — IMMEDIATE ACTIONS

Start today. Run throughout the entire roadmap.

- ☐ Update resume with quantified achievements
- ☐ Update LinkedIn headline + “Open to Work” (recruiters only, if needed)
- ☐ Message 10 people in your network that you’re looking
- ☐ Apply to 5+ roles this week
- ☐ Set a recurring 45-min slot, 2–3×/week, for system design + behavioral practice (starts Week 2, runs to the end)
- ☐ Keep applying every single week from here on — don’t pause for certs

PART 1 — HIGH-LEVEL SEQUENCE CHECKLIST

WEEK	TOPIC	DAILY PACE	CHECKLIST
1-3	Azure Fundamentals	1-1.5 hrs/day	☐ Concepts done ☐ AZ-900 exam booked ☐ AZ-900 passed
4-6	Docker	1-1.5 hrs/day	☐ Concepts + hands-on done ☐ Can containerize an app
7-9	Kubernetes	1.5 hrs/day	☐ Concepts + hands-on done ☐ Can deploy an app to a local cluster (minikube/kind)
10-12	Terraform	1.5 hrs/day	☐ Concepts + hands-on done ☐ Terraform Associate exam booked ☐ Terraform Associate 004 passed
13-15	Node.js	1-1.5 hrs/day	☐ Concepts done ☐ One API built end to end
16-17	React	1-1.5 hrs/day	☐ Concepts done ☐ One app built end to end

WEEK	TOPIC	DAILY PACE	CHECKLIST
18	Next.js	1.5 hrs/day	☐ Concepts done ☐ App migrated/rebuilt in Next.js
19–20	Traditional AI/ML	1–1.5 hrs/day	☐ Concepts done (fluency only — no coding required)
21	Vector Databases	1 hr/day	☐ Concepts done ☐ One small embedding search demo built
22–23	Gen AI / RAG	1.5–2 hrs/day	☐ Concepts done ☐ Mini RAG chatbot built ☐ AI-901 exam booked ☐ AI-901 passed
24–25	Integration Project	2 hrs/day	☐ Next.js + Node API + RAG chatbot built ☐ Containerized with Docker ☐ Deployed to Azure (AKS or App Service) via Terraform
From Wk 2	System Design + Behavioral	45 min, 2–3×/week	☐ 2 system designs/week practiced ☐ 6+ STAR stories ready

~25 weeks (~6 months) at a steady pace. If you already have strong exposure in one area, compress that section and bank the time for weaker areas — don't skip the sequence, just move faster through what you know.

CERT ORDER

1. AZ-900 (Azure Fundamentals)
2. Terraform Associate (004)
3. AI-901 (Azure AI Fundamentals)

JOB-HUNT REMINDER

- Keep applications running every single week
- Roadmap is supporting evidence — not the whole job hunt
- Do not pause applying for certifications